



mental health
in creative
industries

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Mental health includes our physical, emotional and psychological well-being.

Our mental health can greatly affect our creativity and how we see the world around us.

To anyone currently struggling with their mental health, consider indulging in your creative urges.

Designing can become a refuge during difficult times.

Sources

The big mental health report, (2024), Mind.

Long-standing health crisis in creative industries linked to passion driven work research finds, (2025), Creatives Unite.

Cover

Manipulation of *Shocking Wave*
by Brodie Kaman

DID

Creative industries typically have

long work hours and precarious contracts

Working in media (creativity & storytelling)

traps people in cycles of self-sacrifice

?

1 in 4 in England will experience a mental health problem at some point each year

YOU

1 in 5 children and young people in England have a mental health problem

Wide issues in journalism, advertising, film and content creation

lead to anxiety and burnout

KNOW

1 in 8 young people aged 17-19 in England (2024), have an eating disorder or difficulty

Did

YOU

YOU

YOU

I attended the
counselling

last year and

am attending

again this year,
after a second referral

STUDENT

Mental health has affected
my ~~attendance~~ and
commitment to work,
I have difficulty
completing **work**
on time

I found the
5 4 3 2 1 method
very helpful
during
~~panic~~ attacks
and anxiety
I've definitely
struggled
with depression

I've experienced
severe anxiety,
depressive episodes
and
found it
difficult
to attend classes

VOICES*

It was a
nerve-racking time
trying to meet
~~new people~~
and also learn
a completely
new subject

*From the School of Arts &
Communication Design



I am, we are: Different by Design is an annual student-led zine published by the Typography & Graphic Communication department at the University of Reading. This year, the zine was curated, collated and designed by Aurelien Flatman, Eleanor Denton, Grace Johnson, and Jess Scrivener.

This year's edition focuses on four themes. Mental health, menstrual health, community & inclusion, and student finances. These were the most commonly faced issues that students in the School of Art and Communication Design highlighted to us in a survey.

In the University's 100th year, we have brought together student voices from the School of Art & Communication Design. Bringing our communities together for representation.

Design by Eleanor Denton



UoR Mental Health
& Wellbeing



Bectu creative
work union



NABS creative
career support